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As rents go up, money for vouchers may plummet

Housing authorities halt new Section 8 permits amid fear of federal cuts

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

In Massachusetts' brutal housing market, the wait for housing vouchers that help hundreds of thousands afford the state's sky-high rents can stretch as long as 15 years.

Now, that wait may grow even longer.

Most housing authorities in Massachusetts, including the state's housing office, have recently stopped issuing new Section 8 vouchers when tenants give them up. Some are closing waitlists — which can stretch tens of thousands of people long — to new applicants.

Why? A combination of stagnating federal funding over the years and soaring rents in this state have caught up with the Section 8 program, to the point that many housing authorities can no longer afford to pay for the vouchers they distribute to low-income tenants. Together, they've effectively frozen the nation's largest housing assistance program in one of the most expensive housing markets in the US.

And that's at the current funding trajectory, before deep federal cuts that have been proposed by the Trump administration, which local housing officials have said would be catastrophic.

VOUCHERS, Page B4

Tariffs threaten to entangle Ayotte in N.H.

Pain could be pronounced in state as she supports president on other issues

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

For months, most of New England's governors have banded together in an attempt to combat and mitigate the impact of President Trump's trade war with Canada on their local economies.

Kelly Ayotte, New Hampshire's Republican governor, has kept a strategic distance from the rest.

She's expressed concern but refrained from outright criticism of the tariffs. Ayotte opted not to sign a letter from the group last month, addressed to the premiers of Canada's eastern provinces, that called for maintaining their close regional relationship despite international tensions.

And last week she was absent from a meeting between the New England governors and their Canadian counterparts, sending a representative in her place. Ayotte told local press in May she wouldn't attend because she previously had met individually with Canadian officials.

Ayotte is one of two Republican governors in the region; the other, Phil Scott of Vermont, has long governed from the center and voted for former vice president Kamala Harris in 2024, leaving

AYOTTE, Page A10

A day of threats, warnings

Tehran vows to retaliate for attack; Washington calls for return to talks but signals it would punish any reprisals

By Helene Cooper,
John Ismay, Eric Schmitt,
and Ronen Bergman
NEW YORK TIMES

The United States on Sunday warned Iran not to retaliate after a series of surgical strikes by American B-2 bombers and missiles caused what US officials described as "severe damage" to Iran's nuclear operations.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said at a news conference Sunday morning that any retaliation for the strikes "will be met with force far greater than what was witnessed" the previous night.

Hours after the strikes, Iran's Revolutionary Guard threatened to retaliate, possibly by attacking the vast number of US bases and

forces in the Middle East, in a statement carried by the Iranian state news media. "Iran reserves all options to defend its sovereignty, interest, and people," Abbas Araghchi, the Iranian foreign minister, said on social media after the strikes.

Iran's appetite and capacity for a counterstrike are unknown. Especially now that its proxy

forces, including Hamas in the Gaza Strip and Hezbollah in Lebanon, have been hobbled, its leaders do not want to show weakness. Yet Israeli airstrikes in the past week have destroyed at least half of Iran's missile launchers and an unknown number of missiles.

The lack of Iranian air defenses was evident Saturday night, as American bombers flew a 37-hour round-trip mission from Whiteman Air Force Base in Mis-

IRAN, Page A7



ARASH KHAMOOSHI/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Protesters took to a street Sunday in Tehran following US attacks on Iranian nuclear sites. US officials said the damage to the facilities was severe but it remains unclear how much it would set back Iran's nuclear program.

Lawmakers question Trump's unilateral strikes

Congress divided, with some in GOP expressing unease

By Mariana Alfaro
and Azi Paybarah
WASHINGTON POST

President Trump's decision to send US forces to strike Iran without consulting Congress is prompting bipartisan unease among lawmakers, with many Democrats and a handful of Republicans questioning the accuracy of military intelligence to justify the attack as well as the constitutionality of the president's actions.

"When there's a clear and imminent threat to US citizens, to the United States, to the homeland, the commander in chief has a right to act," Senator Mark Kelly, an Arizona Democrat and member of the Senate Intelli-



ALEX BRANDON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Joint Chiefs Chairman General Dan Caine offered details of the strikes Sunday.

gence Committee, said Sunday on NBC's "Meet the Press." "That wasn't the case here."

Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren called the strikes "a horrific war of choice." She also

questioned the Trump administration's reasoning for the attack, citing that the president said the sites were "completely and totally obliterated," while Vice President JD Vance said the intent is

Local concerns

The strikes conjured mixed, and very strong, emotions among those in the Iranian diaspora.

B1.

The Iranian response

It is a delicate balance the government faces between resistance and restraint.

A5.

On high alert

Major US cities are tightening security after attacks.

A7.

to "permanently dismantle that nuclear program over the coming years."

"Which is it?" she said Sunday on X. "Sounds like more endless war against the will of the American people."

Senator Tim Kaine, a Virginia Democrat and member of the

CONGRESS, Page A7

"It was just an astonishing revelation. He wasn't just bright, he was brilliant."

SUMIT DHANDA, on his son's sudden mastery of a spelling exercise

Next step for nonverbal autistic teen: MIT



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Viraj Dhanda received his Fusion Academy Newton diploma earlier this month, with his father, Sumit, at right.

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

BROOKLINE — "Viraj, ready? Have no expectation you're going to get in," said Sumit Dhanda, Viraj Dhanda's father, as the duo prepared to open an email that would declare whether the teen was accepted into MIT. "If you get in, consider it a gift from God."

Holding his breath, Sumit Dhanda clicked open the email. Immediately, virtual confetti exploded across the laptop screen.

"Oh my God, Viraj," his father cried out, overcome by joy, before reading out loud the sentence they were hoping they'd hear that day in March: "On behalf of the admissions committee, it is my pleasure to offer you admission to the MIT class of 2029."

In the video shown to the Globe, his father's excitement was visible, but Viraj Dhanda appeared stoic, almost unresponsive. Inside, however, the teen beamed. The acceptance letter proved wrong every doubt others had about him. Then he smiled.

The Brookline teen is unlike any other MIT applicant. Viraj Dhanda, 19, is a nonspeaking autistic student who spent most of his schooling in classrooms where he was perceived to be intellectually disabled — a gross misdiagnosis that not only delayed his

STUDENT, Page A10

The Thunder won their first NBA title since relocating to OKC, holding off the Indiana Pacers 103-91 in Game 7. C1.

It's not just Boston: The heat wave has people across the Midwest and East heading for air-conditioned rooms and pools. A2.

The president of the Federal Reserve Bank of Boston expects the central bank to cut interest rates at least once this year. D1.

Students and faculty take issue with President Trump calling an entry math class "remedial." B1.

A suicide bomber destroyed much of a Syrian church; at least 20 were killed and dozens wounded. A4.

The defense once more let down the Red Sox as they fall to the Giants, 9-5, in San Francisco. C1.



Tag steam match

Monday: The heat is on. . . High 85-90, low 73-78.

Tuesday: . . . And on and on. High 96-101, low 78-83.

Sunrise: 5:08. Sunset: 8:25.

Weather and comics, D4-5. Obituaries, C9.

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